



PunkBackup — Troubleshooting Manual

This manual shows the app in **English** — go to "■ Settings" → "English" if it isn't already switched (instant, no restart).

"Start backup" does nothing / doesn't change state

- Fully close the app (not just minimize it) and reopen it from the Desktop icon.
- If it happens again, you should now get an error window with the exact detail (instead of failing silently) — send us that text.
- Make sure there isn't another copy of the app already open (check the taskbar).

The iPhone can't reach the server

1. Confirm the iPhone and the PC are on the **same WiFi network** (check the exact name in WiFi settings on both — some routers have separate 2.4GHz/5GHz networks with similar-looking names).
2. From Safari on the iPhone, try opening the address the app shows you (e.g. `http://PC-NAME.local:8787/health`). If it doesn't load, try the "Fallback IP" the app also shows.
3. Confirm the server is on in the PC app ("Status: Listening on port...").
4. Check the Firewall rule exists: PowerShell (as administrator) → `Get-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "PunkBackup"`. If it's missing (e.g. you skipped that checkbox during install), add it with `New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "PunkBackup" -Direction Inbound -Protocol TCP -LocalPort 8787 -Profile Private -Action Allow`.

401 error "Missing or invalid X-Backup-Token header"

- The token in the Shortcut doesn't match your profile's token on the PC.
- In the Shortcut, check **every** action with an X-Backup-Token header — the value must be the Token variable **chip** (colored background), never the literal word "Token" typed as plain text.
- Copy the token again from the app ("Copy token" button on the profile) and paste it into the corresponding **Text** action in the Shortcut.

403 error "This profile is paused"

- The profile is **Paused**. Open the app → "Main" or "■ Settings" → switch it to **Active**.

409 error "no destination folder configured"

- That profile has no destination folder. Go to "■ Settings" → "Choose folder..." for that profile.

The Shortcut runs but doesn't upload any new photo

- Check "**Find Photos**" has no stray filter (it should just say "Find Photos" with no extra conditions, only Sort/Order/Limit) — a filter that sneaks in by accident makes it return 0 results silently, with no visible error.
- If "Find Photos" has a low **Limit** and you've run it several times, it may keep checking the same oldest photos over and over — raise the Limit to make progress.
- Confirm under **iPhone Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Photos** that the Shortcuts app has access ("All Photos" / "Always Allow").

My library is huge (thousands of photos) and the full backup fails or freezes

- "Find Photos" with **no limit** scans your entire library at once — with very large libraries (thousands of photos) this can take a long time or cause iOS to interrupt the Shortcut with a generic error ("There was a problem running the shortcut"). This is a **known limitation**, without a definitive fix yet.
- In the meantime: use a **moderate Limit** (e.g. 300-500) and run the Shortcut several times manually — with a fixed limit it may never reach the oldest photos in a very large library, though. For the initial full backup of a large library, be patient, disable Auto-Lock and keep the phone plugged in, and if it fails, just run it again — the system is incremental, so progress already made isn't lost.

The phone freezes while the Shortcut runs

- Go to **iPhone Settings** → **Display & Brightness** → **Auto-Lock** → **Never** (temporarily, while running a large backup).
- Runs with thousands of photos can take several minutes — that's normal, not a freeze.
- If it truly stops responding: a forced restart of the iPhone is safe, nothing is lost (the server-side run is just left unfinished, harmlessly).

The Shortcut's final notification shows blank numbers (New/Already had/Conflicts)

Known cosmetic issue — the step that closes out the run (`/run/finish`) sometimes doesn't complete, so the summary doesn't always carry the numbers. **This doesn't affect the actual backup**: files still upload and save correctly. To confirm something was really saved, check the destination folder directly (see next section).

How to check files are really being saved

No technical steps needed: open the destination folder you chose in Windows Explorer — you should see Year/Month subfolders with your photos and videos inside.

Still not working

Contact whoever helped you install the system, or check the project's GitHub repository to report the issue.